GOOD NEWS WEEKLY

What actually went right last week

The 5 stories readers chose, week of 26 October

Zoom out: Fifty countries had eliminated at least one neglected tropical disease by 2024. By the end of 2025 it was 58, with 84 diseases seen off in total. (World Health Organization)

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An mRNA vaccine from Merck and Moderna cut melanoma recurrence risk by 42% over two years in a trial of 1,137 patients, with participant Ted Komenda now a year past his last dose and cancer free.

What it proves: Researchers are now testing related vaccines against kidney, bladder, lung, pancreatic and glioblastoma cancers.



Stanford scientists watched a bleached coral fragment regain full color within two weeks after it touched a genetically identical healthy coral in a lab tank.

What it proves: Collins's team is now working to extract and culture the beneficial algae so it could one day be deployed in the field to protect reefs before bleaching hits.



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Josh Law, a 24-year-old US Coast Guard rescue swimmer, followed a helicopter searchlight through pitch darkness and 6 to 8 foot waves to pull 16 people from the Pacific after their boat capsized 140 miles off Mexico's Baja peninsula.

211

A two-year basic income pilot gave 211 people in three Indigenous communities in the Peruvian Amazon no-strings cash transfers, and a University of Bath analysis published this week found it also eased pressure to exploit the forest.

What it proves: Cool Earth, the charity behind the pilot, plans to expand the scheme.



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Port Lincoln fisher Jake Murray and his crewmates found an exhausted kangaroo swimming three kilometres offshore on Saturday 17 October, opened the boat's sea door and brought it safely aboard.

All five stories are linked in the post text above.

“One child, one teacher, one book, one pen can change the world.”

Malala Yousafzai

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